

Document B — Staff Feedback

Exercise 2, Round 2 (Infer). Fictional. Meridian Technical Services.

Background for context: three months ago MTS introduced a mandatory pre-job briefing with digital sign-off. Before any field task begins, the team lead completes a nine-point briefing on a tablet and each team member signs off. It replaces nothing; it was added.

The following 40 comments came from an anonymous survey of field staff.

1. It adds fifteen minutes to every job. On a two-hour task that's not nothing.
2. The app takes forever to load. I've stood in the rain waiting for it.
3. Honestly it's made us stop and think before we start. We caught a valve that was still live last month because someone actually read point four out loud.
4. Nobody trained us. We got an email with a link to a video.
5. We already do a toolbox talk. Now we do a toolbox talk and then this. It's the same information twice.
6. At Kestrel Yard there's no signal at all. You have to walk to the gate to sync.
7. Fifteen minutes each way, three jobs a day. Do the maths.
8. The tablet screen is unreadable in sunlight. I'm holding my jacket over it.
9. It's a good discipline. I was against it and I've changed my mind.
10. The video training was for a different version of the app than the one we have.
11. I can't see why this couldn't be part of the existing job card. Two systems, same questions.
12. Signal is fine at the main sites. It's the outstations that are the problem.
13. It's slow. Not the process — the software. The process is fine.
14. Genuinely I think it's stopped at least one incident on my crew. Whatever it costs, that's worth it.
15. Point four is worded ambiguously. Half of us answer it one way and half the other, and nobody has told us which is right.

16. Add up fifteen minutes across the whole field force and tell me that's a good use of the money.
17. My apprentice has learned more from listening to those briefings than from anything else this year. That wasn't the intention but it's real.
18. Half an hour of my morning is now admin.
19. The sign-off screen times out if you take too long and you lose everything.
20. Nobody explained why we're doing it. If someone had, I'd probably be less annoyed about it.
21. It duplicates the permit. The permit already asks four of these nine questions.
22. When it works it's quick. It's just often it doesn't work.
23. I've started doing it in the van on the way there so we don't lose time on site. I know that's not how it's meant to work but the clock is the clock.
24. It makes the younger lads slow down, which is no bad thing.
25. There's no offline mode. In 2026.
26. Two hours a week, every week, per person. Has anyone actually costed that?
27. The training assumed you'd used the system before. I hadn't.
28. It's a good idea badly implemented. Fix the app and I'd have nothing to complain about.
29. I like it. It's the first thing in years that has actually made the start of a job safer rather than just more documented.
30. Why do I sign to say I've been briefed when I gave the briefing?
31. It's another fifteen minutes I don't have.
32. Sync failures mean I've done the same briefing twice on more than one occasion.
33. We were told it would take five minutes. It takes fifteen.
34. If they'd built it into the job card system nobody would have objected. It's the separateness that annoys people.
35. Nobody showed us what to do when it fails. So we improvise, and I doubt we all improvise the same way.
36. The extra time is real but so is the benefit. I'd keep it.
37. On a long job it's fine. On a short job it's a bigger overhead than the job.
38. Poor connectivity, then it re-syncs and overwrites what you did. Twice now.

39. There's no feedback loop. We fill it in and it goes into a hole. Does anyone read it?
 40. It's fine. It's just one more thing, and there are a lot of one more things.
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End of feedback.